

Peng-Ting (Dean) Kuo

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Education

University of Texas at Austin

Ph.D. in Government
• Major field: Methodology

Austin, TX
2025 - 2030

National Taiwan University (NTU)

MA in Political Science
• Overall GPA: **4.06/4.3**
• Thesis: The Impact of Electoral Reform on Legislators' Campaign Strategies: An Application of Large Language Models

Taipei, Taiwan
2021 - 2024

National Taiwan University (NTU)

BA in Political Science and Minor in Economics
• Last two years GPA: **4.11/4.3**

Taipei, Taiwan
2017 - 2021

Peer-reviewed Publications

LLMs are Biased Evaluators But Not Biased for Fact-Centric Retrieval Augmented Generation. *The 63rd Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL Findings). Vienna, Austria, Jul 27 - Aug 1, 2025. (with Yen-Shan Chen, Jing Jin, Chao-Wei Huang, Yun-Nung Chen)*

Working Papers

Democracy or Prosperity? A Cross-National Analysis of East Asian Countries. *R&R. (with Ronan Tse-min Fu, I-Lien Lee, Chia-Hsiang Han, Yu-Ning Chiu)*

Presented at 2023 Asian Barometer Survey Conference

Explaining China's Security Policy under Xi Jinping: A Neoclassical Realist Approach. *Under Review. (with Ronan Tse-Min Fu, Yu-Ning Chiu)*

Presented at 2024 Prospect Foundation Conference

Decoding Campaigning Strategies: A Machine Learning Approach to Understanding the Impact of Election Systems on Legislative Candidates. *(with Ronan Tse-Min Fu, Nich Lin)*

Presented at 2025 IPSA; 2024 MPSA, JAES; 2023 TPSA

More Trade, More Dispute? Measuring Alliance Effect on WTO Conflict. *(with Wayne Hsuan-Wei Lee)*

Presented at 2026 MPSA

The Continuous Global Leadership Project: A Verifiable AI Search Agent Methodology. *(with Connor Jerzak)*

Presented at 2026 Texas Methods

Professional Experience

Department of Government, University of Texas at Austin

Research Assistant

Austin, TX
Aug 2025 - Present

- Supervised by Prof. John Gerring
- Engineered end-to-end data pipeline from scratch for extracting and structuring institutional data from historical texts using multiple state-of-the-art LLMs (GPT, Claude, LLaMA, Gemini)
- Optimized model performance through systematic experimentation with prompt engineering strategies including few-shot learning and chain-of-thought reasoning, evaluated using F1 scores in pilot studies

Institute of Sociology, Academia Sinica

Research Assistant

Taipei, Taiwan
Apr 2024 - Present

- Supervised by Prof. Wayne Hsuan-Wei Lee
- Analyzed 600+ WTO Dispute Settlement Body cases and 8000+ documents using social network analysis uncovering key patterns and relationships between countries
- Designed data pipeline from scratch, including web scrapping, text pre-processing, Retrieval Augmentation Generation (RAG) system, and data analytics, improving data accessibility for scalable research

Department of Computer Science & Information Engineering, NTU

Research Assistant

Taipei, Taiwan
Aug 2024 - Dec 2024

- Supervised by Prof. Vivian Yun-Nung Chen
- Optimized research design and evaluated bias in LLMs (GPT, LLaMA) using the Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) framework, incorporating social science experimental methodology
- Curated and analyzed 1000+ paired human-AI annotated datasets, developed visualization tools for bias assessment, contributing to a paper presented by the 2025 ACL Findings

Institute of Political Science, Academia Sinica

Research Assistant

- Supervised by Prof. Ronan Tse-Min Fu
- Engineered datasets and conducted statistical analysis on cross-national data from twelve East Asian countries using Python and R, contributed to a publication at the Asian Barometer Survey Conference 2023
- Developed and curated a 2-million-entry news database from China’s People’s Daily. Trained classification models using PyTorch and RoBERTa framework, achieving 96% accuracy in identifying international news
- Developed and maintained an events database on UK-Germany relations, consolidating a comprehensive resource and literature reviews for the book project and regularly reporting progress to the team

Taipei, Taiwan

Mar 2022 - Aug 2025

First Bank

Intern

- Conducted qualitative data collection and developed strategic recommendations to enhance digital bank user experience, earning recognition from managers
- Initiated and organized an experience-sharing session on project management for 50+ interns, strengthening intern-company relationships

Taipei, Taiwan

Jul 2020 - Aug 2020

Invited Talk

Exploring an Interdisciplinary Academic Career in Data Mining and NLP

2024

Department of Political Science, Soochow University

- Guest lectured on applications of NLP in political science research during graduate statistics courses
- Led hands-on Python programming workshops demonstrating NLP implementation

Honors and Awards

Graduate Fellowship in Law and Democracy, <i>UT Austin</i> (\$1000)	2026
Phi Tau Phi Scholastic Honor Society, <i>National Taiwan University</i>	2025
TOEFL ITP Higher Education Research Scholarship, <i>TOEFL Chun-Hsin Limited</i>	2024
Travel Grant for International Conference Participation, <i>National Science and Technology Council; NTU</i>	2024
Diplomatic Scholarship, <i>Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Republic of China (Taiwan)</i>	2022
Yu Ren-Huan Scholarship, <i>Department of Political Science, NTU</i>	2019
Dean’s List Award (Rank 2/46), <i>NTU</i>	2019

Teaching Experience

University of Texas at Austin

Austin, TX

Statistical Analysis in Political Science (GOV350), TA

Spring 2026

World War I in Real Time (GOV355), TA

Fall 2025

Academia Sinica

Taipei, Taiwan

Institution of Social Science Methodology (ISSM), TA

Summer 2025

National Taiwan University (NTU)

Taipei, Taiwan

Applied Deep Learning (CSIE5431), TA

Fall 2024

Computational Social Science (PS5697), TA

Spring 2024

Basic Mathematics for Social Science (PS5710), TA

Fall 2023

Social Network and Group Behavior (PS5705), TA

Spring 2023

Seminar on Game Theory (PS5019), TA

Fall 2022

International Law (PS3316, PS3317), TA

Fall 2021 - Spring 2024

Other Training

Summer Institute in Computational Social Science

Rochester, NY

University of Rochester

Summer 2026

Institute for Political Methodology

Taipei, Taiwan

Academia Sinica

Summer 2022

Skills

Language	Mandarin, English, Japanese
Programming	Python, PyTorch, R, Netlogo
Software Skills	TeX, Git, Linux